

ENGLISH LANGUAGE PAPER 4

PART A Group Interaction

Below is an extract from a magazine interview with a teenager:

Why I dance *by Sugar Chan*

I have been dancing since secondary school.

The first dance group I ever belonged to was the Hong Kong Youth Dance Group, which provided me – and still provides its members – with regular training in dance techniques. It also gave me a chance to perform different types of dance such as Hip Hop, Jazz, Funk and Modern Dance.

I was in the dance group for three years and it was truly a unique experience. I didn't just learn dance steps and techniques, I also made friends and became myself. For this, I have to give credit to my dance teachers who also became my life teachers. I learnt so much from them, both about dance and self-awareness. Apart from teaching me about performing on stage, they also kept asking me, 'What are you doing here? Who are you? Why do you perform? Is it just for yourself or are you trying to attract attention?'

Those questions meant a lot to me as I was growing up and I have asked myself the same questions many times. As a teenager, dance was transformative and helped me to find myself. I now understand that I dance not to please the audience. I dance for myself. I dance because I am.

As members of the Hong Kong Youth Dance Group, your group is giving a presentation during assembly to encourage fellow classmates to join the group. You may want to talk about:

- whether Hong Kong teenagers like dancing
- what teens can learn from dance
- what activities can be organized to promote the group
- anything else you think is important

PART B Individual Response

1. Do you enjoy watching dancing?
2. Would you like to dance on stage?
3. What would your parents say if you wanted to join a dance group?
4. Would you recommend that your school includes dance as a learning activity?
5. Would you prefer to dance solo or in a group?
6. What can be learned from performing on stage?
7. Do people dance to attract attention?
8. Is traditional dance losing its appeal?